

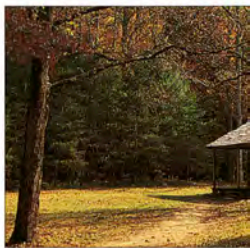


PIONEERS



During the 19th century, European settlers traveled across America in search of land to farm. They were called pioneers. Some of them traveled in wagon trains so long that they stretched as far as the eye could see. The wagons were packed tight with provisions—food, tools, plows, household goods, and even chamber pots. There was often only enough room for small children, the sick, and some women to ride in the wagons. Everyone else walked alongside.

Tormented by the heat and dust, or by winds, rain, and snow, the pioneers trudged across prairies and climbed over mountains. They lived and slept outdoors, and often went without food and water. The pioneers also faced attacks from Native Americans who resented the Europeans taking their land from them.



The wagons were pulled by teams of horses, mules, or oxen.



The wheels in the front were made smaller than those in the back, so that the wagon could be steered more easily.

The lure of gold

Prospectors were people who hunted for gold. They would fill a shallow pan with gravel from a riverbed and wash the stones out of the pan with water. Then they looked for any gold that might have sunk to the bottom.



When gold was discovered in Australia, America, South Africa, and Canada in the 19th century, Europeans flocked to these countries to make their fortune.

